



Partly sunny, windy 36/23 • Tomorrow: Cold 32/19 B6

Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, JANUARY 7, 2025 • \$4



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

Congress certifies Trump's election without incident

HARRIS PRESIDES AS LOSS BECOMES OFFICIAL

Democrats recall chaos of 2021 in remarks, memorial

BY PAUL KANE,
MARIANNA SOTOMAYOR,
MARIANA ALFARO
AND LIZ GOODWIN

Congress speedily certified the 2024 election results on Monday, as lawmakers gathered at the Capitol to formalize Donald Trump's win despite a snowstorm that has ground most of the city to a halt.

The unremarkable, half-hour proceedings contrasted sharply with the last certification, when a mob of Donald Trump's supporters violently disrupted the event in an attempt to pressure lawmakers and then-Vice President Mike Pence not to certify Joe Biden's win.

This time, Vice President Kamala Harris presided over formalizing her own loss, as Democrats applauded each time a vote for her was tallied while Republi-

cans cheered when Trump's votes were counted. Members of both parties applauded as Harris announced her own 226 electoral votes compared with Trump's 312.

"Congress certifies our great election victory today — a big moment in history. MAGA!" Trump wrote on social media.

After the proceedings, Harris appeared to reference the events of Jan. 6, 2021, when she told reporters gathered in the Capitol that American democracy "is only as strong as our willingness to fight for it."

"Otherwise it is very fragile, and it will not be able to with-

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The gavel: Eight years apart, Biden and Harris certify Trump wins. **A8**

Pardons: Capitol Police chief opposes clemency for assaults. **B1**

Strong storm packs a wallop

Power outages, traffic snarls follow as snow treks east

This article is by Ben Noll, Kasha Patel, Matthew Cappucci, Lori Aratani and Jonathan Edwards

A wide-reaching winter storm dropped more than a foot of snow and closed major highways in parts of the Midwest before continuing its Monday trek eastward. In parts of the Great Plains, snow totals exceeded anything seen in decades. At least three fatalities were reported in two traffic incidents in the Midwest.

The storm produced wintry precipitation across a distance of about 1,500 miles — from Kansas to New York — creating hazardous conditions for millions of people, and for some their biggest snowstorm in years. More than 12 inches fell in Kansas; Missouri experienced blizzard conditions; and in the Mid-Atlantic, roads

SEE SNOWSTORM ON A20



CRAIG HUDSON FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Closures abound; schools will remain shuttered Tuesday

BY DAN ROSENZWEIG-ZIFF,
DANA HEDGPETH
AND KYLE SWENSON

Snow blanketed the D.C. area Monday, as schools and federal offices closed, airlines canceled hundreds of flights, and Richmond officials urged residents to boil their water after a pump failed because of the weather.

Schools across the region will remain shuttered again Tuesday as local governments, residents and others begin the task of clearing streets.

About 5 to 9 inches of snow fell as of early Monday evening, creating a winter wonderland of fun and slush the area had not seen in years. When the precipitation ends overnight, it will mark the highest single storm snow totals at Reagan National Airport since

SEE REGION ON A20

TOP: Capitol Police officers stand guard in the snow outside the U.S. Capitol as security tightened ahead of the joint session of Congress to certify the presidential election result.

ABOVE: Charessa Fryc lets one fly during Monday's snowball fight at Meridian Hill Park in Northwest Washington. **Story, B1**

New cardinal is known as advocate for migrants

BY MICHELLE BOORSTEIN,
ANTHONY FAIOLA,
STEFANO PITRELLI AND
EMILY WAX-THIBODEAUX

The Vatican on Monday named one of the leading liberal prelates in the United States to run the prominent Washington-area archdiocese, sending to the nation's capital, as a second Trump administration begins, a cleric known for a pastoral approach to migrants and for the "radical inclusion" of the LGBTQ+ community.

That approach came through prominently as San Diego Cardinal Robert McElroy made his first appearance after the announcement. Speaking at the Cathedral of St. Matthew the Apostle in Washington, the new archbishop delivered a message of unity and gratitude.

He thanked Pope Francis, celebrated African Americans as "so foundational" to his new archdiocese and addressed its Hispanic

community in Spanish. He also called for inclusion and stressed the importance of trying to understand the "other."

McElroy, who for a decade has headed a diocese running the length of California's southern border with Mexico, asked Americans to "hope and pray" that the next White House administration is successful in "helping to enhance our society, our country, our life and the whole of our nation." But he acknowledged a possible "contrast" with the next administration's priorities on immigration.

"The Catholic church teaches that a nation has the right to control its borders and our nation's desire to do that is a legitimate effort," he continued. "At the same time, we are called always to have a sense of the dignity of every human person. And thus, plans that have been talked about at some levels of

SEE ARCHDIOCESE ON A9



McElroy



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/AP

The Bidens mourn on Bourbon Street

President Joe Biden and first lady Jill Biden visit the site of the New Year's Day terrorist attack that left 14 people dead in New Orleans. While in the grief-stricken city, the Bidens attended a prayer service and met privately with families affected by the massacre as well as officers who responded to it. **Story, A7**

Trudeau to resign, paving way for new leadership

BY AMANDA COLETTA

TORONTO — Bowing to pressure from opponents and allies alike, Justin Trudeau — whose championing of progressive politics rocketed him into the international spotlight as Canada's prime minister but who has faced growing headwinds at home — announced Monday that he intends to resign as Liberal leader, making way for a new prime minister.

Speaking to reporters outside Rideau Cottage, an official residence in Ottawa, Trudeau said he intends to stay on as prime minister until his successor is chosen in a "robust" leadership race. He said that Governor General Mary Simon — the representative in Canada of King Charles III, the country's head of state — granted his request to prorogue, or discontinue, the current session of

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IN THE NEWS

Gaza's winter tragedy With little refuge from the elements, at least seven Palestinian infants have died in the cold in recent weeks, said relatives, doctors and officials. **A10**

South Korea in crisis The political turmoil in Seoul has called into question the United States' alliance-building efforts in Asia. **A13**

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A Louisiana man is the first U.S. fatality from H5N1 avian influenza, officials said. **A4**

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A "dinosaur highway" has tracks that were left 166 million years ago, researchers found. **A12**

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Nippon Steel and U.S. Steel sued President Joe Biden over the blocking of their deal, alleging a corrupt bid for political support. **A15**

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A nurse was arrested after several newborn babies suffered "unexplainable fractures" at Henrico Doctors' Hospital in Virginia. **B1**

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Ten influential journalists shared their thoughts on the best approach to covering Donald Trump's second term. **C1**
HEALTH & SCIENCE
The sky depicted in Vincent van Gogh's "The Starry Night" intrigues not only art lovers, but also physicists. **E1**

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